



STATUS REPORT

Burundi: status report

Edition of 2026-08-25 · 65 systems and instruments tracked

Compiled 2026-08-25 by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository, from [outputs/reports/BDI/Ledger.csv](#) (65 systems and instruments, 10 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

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Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Burundi built a great deal of digital public infrastructure in the twelve months to August 2026 on a network that its own regulator says is degrading. [BurundiPay, the national instant payment rail, opened on 23 April 2026](#); the [first personal data protection law was adopted on 15 January 2026](#); a national AI strategy was validated on 22 April 2026; and the [biometric national identity card was presented as technically ready](#).

Against that, [ARCT says internet quality is degraded and traces it mainly to the electricity supply](#). The identity card awaits a legal instrument, the data protection authority the January law creates is not on record as operating, and the [one attempt on file to enforce a consent obligation is reported to have changed nothing](#). The sequencing is the government's own: the law was adopted in order to make the card lawful.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Data Governance Strategy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Validated with seven pillars, UNECA-supported and AU Data Policy Framework-aligned
Proposed mobile-phone ban for civil servants	PLANNED ↗	Proposed by the president, office landlines to replace mobile phones

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Access to information bill	PLANNED ↗	Listed on the National Assembly's order paper for the session opened 3 August 2026

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Anti-money-laundering and counter-terrorist-financing regime	ENACTED ↗	Five central bank circulars issued, FATF-aligned

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ARCT injunctions on value-added-service consent	ENACTED ↗	Injunctions issued to Lumitel requiring genuinely voluntary subscription and prior notification
Data protection authority	PLANNED ↗	Created by the January 2026 law; no appointment, budget or decision on file
Personal data protection law	ENACTED ↗	Unanimously adopted by the National Assembly, 15 January 2026
Data-sharing agreement under the United States health-sector memorandum	NOT HELD	—

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
AfCFTA country implementation roadmap	PLANNED ↗	Technical team agreed 3 August 2026, during the AfCFTA Secretary-General's mission to Bujumbura, to produce a country profile and implementation roadmap jointly owned by government and the private sector
EAC One Network Area and Regional Digital Integration protocol	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Joined the One Network Area and ratified the protocol
Vietnam-Burundi telecommunications-technology memorandum	ENACTED ↗	Implementation meeting held 28 July 2026, party-to-party rather than ministry-to-ministry

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National technical standards or interoperability framework	NOT HELD	No national framework on file; the standards work on record is regional

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Etats generaux de la communication	PLANNED ↗	Proposed by the consumer association ABUCO; no convening date on file

Burundi's [first personal data protection law](#) was adopted unanimously on 15 January 2026: eight chapters, an independent authority, criminal penalties, aligned to the Malabo Convention. The authority it creates is not on record as appointed, funded or having taken a decision.

The one attempt on file to enforce something consent-shaped was made by a different regulator. ARCT [issued injunctions to Lumitel on 29 May 2026](#) requiring genuinely voluntary subscription and prior notification for value-added services, after the consumer association ABUCO complained that subscribers were enrolled without their knowledge. ABUCO reports no significant improvement two months on; Lumitel maintains that nothing activates without a customer's deliberate action; no sanction is on file.

Two framework documents sit above the law. The [National Data Governance Strategy](#) was validated in November 2025 with seven pillars and UNECA support. An [access-to-information bill](#) was listed on the National Assembly's order paper for the session opened on 3 August 2026 — no text, tabling number, sponsoring ministry or timetable published, and no access-to-information statute on file to date.

Burundi joined the [EAC One Network Area](#) and ratified the [Regional Digital Integration](#) protocol. The [Vietnam memorandum's implementation meeting of 28 July 2026](#) ran through the ruling party rather than the ministry, Vietnam's stated ask being that Burundi create conditions for Lumitel, the Viettel subsidiary already carrying the larger half of the rural build. The AfCFTA Secretary-General's [mission to Bujumbura on 3 August 2026](#) closed with agreement to produce a country profile and implementation roadmap jointly owned by government and the private sector, tied by the minister to Burundi's African Union Chairmanship. No national interoperability framework or technical standard is held; the standards work on record is regional.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Execution discipline of voted appropriations	UNDER REVIEW ↗	Mid-year work-plan report showed credits shifted between programmes with a 2.7% overrun

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
United States health-sector memorandum	ENACTED ↗	Five-year agreement signed, including health-data management

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
PAFEN Digital Foundations Project	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Mid-term review put commitment at 61%

One institution dominates the financing. Every non-state digital-transformation deal the base holds for Burundi is World Bank, across four operations running from 2021 to 2029; the amounts are set out in the published finance table for Burundi rather than here, because they are this base's own compilation of scattered records and not a figure any source states. The vehicle is [PAFEN](#), at 61% committed at mid-term.

Domestic money is unusually well documented for a country this size. The [communications and ICT ministry's vote tripled to BIF 131.7bn in FY2024/25](#) from BIF 43.1bn, and the [FY2026/27 general budget was adopted at expenditure above BIF 7,020bn against revenue of BIF 6,296.03bn, up 23.76%](#). But the same loi de règlement records revenue realised at BIF 3,234bn, 76.79% of the revised target, and a [mid-year work-plan report showed credits shifted between programmes with a 2.7% overrun](#). A voted digital line is not a spent one.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Fonds de service universel institutional connectivity	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	FY2026/27 revised appropriation of BIF 11.40bn for dedicated IP transit to health facilities and schools

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ICT infrastructure-sharing law	PLANNED ↗	Named by the regulator as a draft law; no text published
Mobile and internet network quality	UNDER REVIEW ↗	Regulator published its own diagnosis of degraded quality and named six causes
PAFEN mast-deployment programme	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Named by the regulator as financed and in train
PAFEN rural 4G build	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	ONATEL contracted for 92 hills after Lumitel's contract for 86
Starlink licence	IMPLEMENTED, PRICED OUT OF REACH ↗	Licensed but effectively unavailable on cost, the kit alone at roughly US\$500

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National data centre	PLANNED ↗	Named a PAFEN mid-term priority alongside public-finance modernisation and the national ID

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Powering of mobile base stations	PLANNED ↗	Study planned by the regulator; no instrument or programme

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Compute or high-performance computing capacity	NOT HELD	No source on file

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Regional financial-system cybersecurity measures	PLANNED ↗	EAC central bank governors flagged the risk as requiring stronger common measures

The regulator has published its own diagnosis of the network. ARCT names six causes of degraded internet quality: power cuts forcing base stations onto generators, difficulty fuelling those generators, unstable supply from the utility REGIDESO, urban bandwidth saturation, ageing transmission equipment and absence of masts. Four of the six are electricity, directly or at one remove. An earlier account attributed outages to power, fuel and foreign-exchange shortages, so the position at both ends of the window is the same.

Three remedies are named and none is yet an instrument: a draft infrastructure-sharing law, a PAFEN-financed mast-deployment programme, and a planned study on powering mobile sites. The funded one addresses coverage; the cause the regulator puts first is at study stage.

The rural build is the substantial commitment: ONATEL contracted for 92 hills covering 372,035 people at US\$5.9m, after Lumitel's partnership above US\$10m for 86 hills across 14 provinces. The universal service fund carries a revised FY2026/27 appropriation of BIF 11.40bn for IP transit to health facilities and schools, from its own levy on operator turnover.

Satellite does not close the gap: Starlink is licensed but effectively unavailable on cost, the kit alone at roughly US\$500. A national data centre is a stated PAFEN priority with no build, site or date on file.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
EAC cross-border secure data-sharing framework	ENACTED ↗	Validated in Dar es Salaam under the East Africa Regional Digital Integration Project

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Biometric national identity card	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Unveiled as technically ready but awaiting the law or decree governing its use
Digital civil registry platform	PILOTING ↗	Interoperability with health facilities running in 123 facilities, stated by the interior ministry 2026-08-11

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
BurundiPay national instant payment system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Public launch 23 April 2026; 17 of 78 licensed institutions live by 4 August 2026 (5 commercial banks, 10 microfinance institutions, 2 payment institutions), with integration mandatory for all licensed institutions by 5 September 2026 under a BIF 1m-per-month-of-delay penalty
EAC Regional Cross-Border Payment System Master Plan	PLANNED ↗	Central bank told the regional governors it expects to join by December 2026
Mobile-money systems interconnected by BurundiPay	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Lumicash, Ecocash, E-noti and Cashtel named as the systems it links
PAPSS accession	IMPLEMENTED ↗	BRB acceded to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System; four Burundian banks authorised to participate (as at 4 August 2026)
Payment switch migration to ISO 20022	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Migration completed by the central bank

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
2027 electoral register preparation	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Opposition parties demanded suspension of the electoral commission's preparations
Electronic land-title register	IMPLEMENTED, FEE CONTESTED ↗	Mandatory electronic land-title fee ordinance drew objections on cost and deadline

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
CEM/CFP training-centre monitoring tool	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Tool validated 2026-08-07
ELMIS/MEDEXIS health supply-chain system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reached all public and faith-based facilities
Merankabandi social protection on openIMIS	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Migration completed, covering 1.25m beneficiaries
SIGFP_BI integrated public finance management system	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Single-source award contested by a non-governmental organisation

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Daily transfer of telepaid taxes	ENACTED ↗	Revised FY2025/26 finance law sets a penalty of 100% of the amount collected for a bank missing the deadline
e-KORI online tax platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 19 January 2026 for online declaration and payment; from 4 August 2026 all new taxpayer registrations processed exclusively online via e-KORI
Guichets uniques de prestation (one-stop service desks)	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Operationalisation named in the civil-service ministry's reform programme
OBR electronic Guichet Unique (single window)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Put into production with the ABREMA pharmaceutical-import module
Paperless Council of Ministers	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Named in the finance and digital-economy minister's stock-take

Payments moved furthest. [BurundiPay opened on 23 April 2026](#), making banks, microfinance institutions and mobile money interoperable on ISO 20022 and USSD at about 1,000 transactions per second; the minister later [named Lumicash, Ecocash, E-noti and Cashtel as the systems it links](#). By 4 August 2026, [17 of 78 licensed institutions were live](#) — five banks, ten microfinance institutions, two payment institutions — with about 224,000 users and BIF 4.29 billion cumulative volume; the rest have until 5 September 2026 to integrate, on pain of a BIF 1m-per-month fine. The central bank has also [acceded to PAPSS, the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System, with four banks authorised](#). What the rail sits on has not moved: [deposits and withdrawals were about 45% of digital-payment value in Q2 2025](#), and about 1.6m of 7.6m mobile wallets were active. Cross-border within the EAC, governors meeting in Kampala in July 2026 [decided BurundiPay must interconnect with other member states' payment systems](#); the master plan's own first activities remain work plans, priorities and resource mobilisation.

Identity is the file with the longest slip. The card was [confirmed unavailable for the 2025 voter enrolment](#); by May 2026 the interior ministry [presented the digital civil registry and the card as technically ready to produce, but awaiting the law or decree governing their use](#). Every citizen is to re-register afresh, the family code requires amendment, and the [whole-project cost is put at about BIF 15bn](#). The first domestic appropriation followed: [BIF 16.0bn proposed in the draft FY2026/27 budget](#). By 10 August 2026, [13 communes were running biometric civil-registration enrolment, decentralised to zone level and interoperable with health-facility birth and death records, ahead of a planned national unique identifier using fingerprint and facial biometrics](#); UNICEF figures cited on the same occasion put under-5 birth registration at 84% but birth-certificate holding at only 66%.

Burundi has an enumerated population for the first time since 2008. [Décret n°100/032 of 27 March 2025 published preliminary results of the 2024 census](#): 12,332,788 residents, 5,901,069 men and 6,431,719 women, 75.0% rural, against the five provinces of the 2023 territorial reform rather than the eighteen that preceded it — no province series crosses 2008 and 2024. Definitive results remain unpublished.

Tax and trade administration is the most complete part of the stack. [e-KORI opened for online declaration and payment on 19 January 2026](#); from 4 August 2026 all new taxpayer registrations are processed exclusively online [through e-KORI](#), commercial registration routed from the development agency's easybusiness.bi and cooperative registration from ANACOOOP, with biometric enrolment for natural persons. The revenue authority's [electronic single window went into production with a pharmaceutical-import module in February 2026](#). A bank missing the deadline to route telepaid receipts [faces a penalty of 100% of the amount collected](#). The hardware underneath has not moved: [only 500 of 10,000 electronic invoicing machines ordered had been delivered](#), cited in the FY2024/25 loi de règlement as a cause of the revenue shortfall.

Registries are further along than the identity layer they will depend on. Merankabandi runs on openMIS with 1.25m beneficiaries; the health supply chain reached 956 public and faith-based facilities and more than 2,000 users; land services are digitised, with a mandatory electronic land-title fee ordinance objected to on cost and the shortness of its deadline. The integrated public finance management system is under a contested single-source award, envelope put at about US\$30m; the allegations are reported, not established.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digitisation of communal administration	NOT HELD	No source on file describing a commune-level system

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Villages Numeriques programme	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Named in the PAFEN broadband account targeting 80% territorial coverage

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
AI governance and data ethics capacity	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	First documented workshop, run by an alumni association rather than a regulator
National AI Strategy 2026-2030	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Validated 22 April 2026 with six pillars
Sovereign cloud and data hubs	PLANNED ↗	A pillar of the AI strategy, built around the SETIC data centre

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Lyca Mobile market entry	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Licensed October 2025; telecom and e-health plans advanced

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Local AI builds	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	MineGuard and AfriPrompt named at the July 2026 governance workshop

The National AI Strategy 2026-2030 was validated on 22 April 2026 with six pillars, a target of training more than 1,000 officials and about 15 health and agriculture pilots. It was preceded by an AI-readiness diagnostic in November 2025.

The first documented governance discussion of it happened outside government. A two-day workshop in Bujumbura in July 2026, run by an association of German Academic Exchange Service alumni, put the load-bearing point on data rather than algorithms: Burundi has legislated on personal data but holds a great deal of information and little of it as structured, consented, usable data. MineGuard and AfriPrompt were named as local builds. Where the capacity sits is worth recording: an alumni association and university lecturers, not a regulator.

External cooperation is where the sector's money is. Burundi [opened talks with India in June 2026 to adapt India Stack](#), Aadhaar-style identity linked to instant payments, as a cheaper and less vendor-dependent path than the one it is on. The [United States signed a five-year US\\$156m health-sector agreement in February 2026](#) including health-data management. In the domestic market, [Lyca Mobile was licensed in October 2025 and has advanced telecom and e-health plans](#) without a service launch on file. No Chinese or Gulf-state digital investment is held.

Capacity

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital literacy programme or measurement	NOT HELD	No programme document or measurement on file

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Vietnamese training and equipment provision	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reported delivery of 50 desktop computer sets and Master's scholarships in computer science

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
University and professional research capacity in AI and data	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	First documented workshop drew university lecturers, doctors, developers and students

Inclusion

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Rural coverage target	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	PAFEN broadband programme targeting 80% of the territory

Access moved the wrong way on price. The consumer association ABUCO [states that internet package tariffs have more than doubled since January 2025](#), against an instruction to operators that year to improve quality and accessibility. It proposes états généraux of the sector; no response is on file.

On capacity, [Vietnam reports having supplied 50 desktop computer sets and Master's scholarships in computer science](#). No digital-literacy programme or measurement is held.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
EAC Statistics Bureau	ENACTED ↗	Bill endorsed by the East African Legislative Assembly with Burundian amendments
Population census	ENACTED, PRELIMINARY RESULTS ONLY ↗	Décret n°100/032 (27 March 2025) publishes preliminary results 'pour tout usage, en attendant la publication des résultats définitifs'; definitive results not yet published

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Open government data portal	NOT HELD	No portal or open-data policy on file; the access-to-information bill has no published text

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Earth-observation or satellite data programme	NOT HELD	No source on file

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
United States health-sector agreement	ENACTED ↗	Five-year memorandum signed, including health-data management

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Chinese digital investment in Burundi	NOT HELD	No source on file

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
European Union digital cooperation with Burundi	NOT HELD	No source on file

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Gulf-state digital investment in Burundi	NOT HELD	No source on file

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
India Stack cooperation	PLANNED ↗	Talks opened to adapt Aadhaar-style identity linked to instant payments

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Compute or high-performance computing capacity	A data-centre, cloud or high-performance computing specification, or a hosting contract for a public system.	2026-08-09
Digitisation of communal administration	A commune-level revenue or service system specification, or the instrument behind the communal-revenue digitalisation budget line.	2026-08-09
Earth-observation or satellite data programme	A national earth-observation or geospatial-data programme document, or an agency mandate covering satellite data.	2026-08-09

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National technical standards or interoperability framework	A national interoperability framework, technical standard or e-government architecture document.	2026-08-09
Open government data portal	The text of the access-to-information bill, an open-data policy, or a public-sector data portal.	2026-08-09
European Union digital cooperation with Burundi	Any EU or European Investment Bank digital financing, programme or memorandum covering Burundi.	2026-08-09
Chinese digital investment in Burundi	Any Chinese financing, contract or memorandum covering Burundian digital infrastructure.	2026-08-09
Gulf-state digital investment in Burundi	Any Gulf-state investment, financing or memorandum covering Burundian digital infrastructure.	2026-08-09
Digital literacy programme or measurement	A digital-literacy programme document, or a published measurement of digital literacy.	2026-08-09
Data-sharing agreement under the United States health-sector memorandum	The data-sharing agreement itself, a signature date, or a Burundian government statement naming it. The memorandum of 2026-02-09 is held; on the United States government account each such memorandum carries at least one further data-sharing agreement, and those texts are withheld rather than unpublished, in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia	not yet probed

The not-held rows fall into two groups. Four are absences of any source: satellite and earth-observation data, compute capacity, and Chinese and Gulf-state investment. The rest are absences of an instrument where the base establishes something ought to exist: no interoperability framework beneath a stack of interoperating systems, and no open-data policy beneath an access-to-information bill with no published text. The population figure these systems and registers were sized against is no longer one of the gaps: a [2024 enumerated count of 12,332,788](#) supersedes the projection the identity card, civil registry, social register and electoral roll had been sized against.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.